loop.

BUSINESS & SCALING PLAN · DRAFT FOR DISCUSSION

turning scroll time into study time.

A 3-year plan to take loop. from a live MVP at one university to a revision layer used across European universities: pricing, unit economics, go-to-market, financial projections and the funding we need.

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All projections are estimates built on stated assumptions, to be validated in pilots.

1 · SUMMARY

the plan on one page

Students review only when exams force them to, because course material (long slide decks, readings, recorded lectures) isn't built for quick, frequent revision. **loop.** turns a course's own material into a 5-minute, swipeable feed: ***swipe to learn*** (30–90-second concepts and video clips), ***swipe to test*** (a recall question every two cards) and ***swipe to reinforce*** (missed questions return before the exam).

€1.2M revenue in year 3	**200k** registered students by year 3 (≈1% of EU students)	**3.5 : 1** student LTV : CAC	**€400k** pre-seed for 18 months

- **Model:** freemium for students (daily feed free, **exam mode €4.99/month**) plus **university licences at €10 per student per year**. B2C builds the habit and the proof; B2B brings the revenue.
- **Go-to-market:** one class at a time. Start at IE, spread through class groups, ambassadors and professor pilots to 10 Spanish universities in year 1, then Portugal, Italy and France.
- **Financials:** €115k → €400k → €1.2M revenue (×3.5, ×3.0), reaching break-even in year 3.
- **Ask:** €400k pre-seed for 18 months to ship the AI video clipper and slide generator, win 6 paid university licences, reach 20,000 students and €25k monthly revenue, then raise a seed round.

2 · TRACTION SO FAR

two weeks, real signals

15 sign-ups, all organic, €0 spent	**7** classmates tested the MVP	**3 / 5** average usefulness (v0.1)	**1 week** from idea to live MVP

The live MVP (studywithloop.github.io/app/) already runs a course feed with recall questions and a review round, clips assigned YouTube videos with recall pauses, and lets students build a feed from their own slides. A 3/5 usefulness score on a first version is a starting point, not a result: the next iterations focus on what testers flagged, and the target for the pilot is ≥ 4/5 with ≥ 30% of students returning in week 2.

3 · MARKET

start small, grow out

We size the market bottom-up, from the first students we can reach to the whole of Europe, rather than claiming "1% of a huge market".

STEP	STUDENTS	SOURCE	HOW WE REACH THEM
Our classes	≈ 100	own network	class groups, QR stickers, demo in class
IE University	10,000+	Wikipedia (to confirm with IE)	ambassadors per programme, professor pilots
Spain (SAM)	1.83M	2024–25, Cadena SER via Wikipedia (to confirm with Ministry)	10 universities in year 1, licences from year 2
EU (TAM)	19.1M	Eurostat, 2024	Portugal, Italy, France in year 3

In euros: at a realistic €25 per paying student per year, the EU student market is worth about **€478M a year** (19.1M × €25); Spain alone about **€46M**. Our year-3 target, 200,000 registered students, is about 1% of EU students; 13,000 of them paying.

competition: the demand is already there

ALTERNATIVE	WHAT STUDENTS USE IT FOR	WHAT'S MISSING
ChatGPT, NotebookLM	Explaining notes, summaries	Need prompts and a sit-down session; don't know the course
Quizlet, Anki	Flashcards, spaced repetition	No explanations; students must make the cards
TikTok, YouTube	Short explanations	Not their syllabus or professor
Lecture slides	The "official" source	Long, fragmented, not made for quick revision
loop.	**Their own course, 5 minutes a day, active recall and spaced review built in, every card linked to its source**	

Why we can win: course context (no prompts), professor approval (trust), and a habit loop designed for the minutes students already spend on their phones. Large players could add similar features, so our defensibility comes from university relationships, course-level content and the data on which concepts students actually miss.

4 · BUSINESS MODEL

free to start. paid for exams.

PLAN	PRICE	WHAT'S INCLUDED	WHO PAYS
Free	€0	Daily feed for your courses, quick checks	—
Exam mode	€4.99 / month or €29 / year	Spaced review timed to exam dates, unlimited own uploads, video clipping	Students (average ≈ €25 per paying student per year)
University licence	€10 / student / year	Exam mode for a whole programme, professor approval tools, class dashboard of most-missed concepts	Universities, faculties or programmes

unit economics: students (B2C)

METRIC	VALUE	ASSUMPTION
Cost per registered student	€0.80	Mostly organic: ambassadors (≈ €400/semester each), stickers, events, content
Free → paid conversion	6%	5% in year 1, rising to 6.5% with exam-season prompts
CAC per paying student	**€13**	€0.80 ÷ 6%
Revenue per paying student	€25 / year	Mix of monthly (exam seasons) and annual plans
Gross margin	85%	AI content is generated once per lecture and shared by the whole class
Paying lifetime	2.2 years	Of a 4-year degree
LTV	**€47**	€25 × 85% × 2.2
LTV : CAC	**3.5 : 1**	**Payback ≈ 8 months**

unit economics: universities (B2B)

METRIC	VALUE	ASSUMPTION
Average licence	€15k → €20k / year	1,500–2,000 students per programme × €10
CAC per licence	≈ €6k	Sales time, a free pilot term, travel
Licence lifetime	3 years	Annual renewal after a successful pilot
LTV : CAC	**≈ 6 : 1**	**€15k × 85% × 3 ÷ €6k; typical for B2B, slower sales cycle**

These are planning estimates, not benchmarks from comparable companies. They will be replaced with real numbers from the first pilots (conversion, retention, cost per sign-up).

5 · GO-TO-MARKET & SCALING

one class at a time.

The growth loop is built into the product: every feed ends with “send to my class”, so each student who finds it useful can bring in a whole class group. Professors turn classes into programmes; programmes turn into licences.

Phase 1 months 0–6	**Prove it at IE.** Ship the AI video clipper and the slide generator. 3 professor pilots (one course each), 10 student ambassadors, Instagram #coolkidsstayintheloop, QR stickers on campus. Target: 5,000 registered students, week-2 return ≥ 30%, usefulness ≥ 4/5.
Phase 2 months 6–12	**Spain: 10 universities.** Ambassador programme in Madrid, Barcelona and Valencia universities; launch exam mode before winter and spring exam seasons. Convert pilots into the first 6 paid programme licences. Target: 20,000 registered, 1,000 paying, €115k revenue.
Phase 3 year 2	**Spain at scale + Portugal.** Sales lead for universities, professor dashboard, accounts and spaced repetition. Target: 70,000 registered, 4,200 paying, 16 licences, €400k revenue. Raise a seed round on these numbers.
Phase 4 year 3	**Southern Europe.** Italy and France via partner universities and Erasmus networks; localised content generation. Target: 200,000 registered, 13,000 paying, 42 licences, €1.2M revenue, break-even.

operations

- **Content:** one feed per lecture, generated with AI from the professor’s material, checked against the source and approved by the professor before release.
- **Sales:** pilot first (free for one term), then a programme licence; university buyers are deans and learning-innovation teams.
- **Compliance:** GDPR by design: minimal student data, professor permission for course material, videos linked rather than re-hosted, university data-processing agreements.

6 · FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

€1.2M by year 3.

DRIVERS	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Registered students (end of year)	20,000	70,000	200,000
Paying conversion	5%	6%	6.5%
Paying students	1,000	4,200	13,000
Revenue per paying student	€25	€26	€27
University licences	6	16	42
Average licence	€15k	€18k	€20k

PROFIT & LOSS (€)	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Student subscriptions	25,000	109,000	351,000
University licences	90,000	288,000	840,000
Revenue	**115,000**	**397,000**	**1,191,000**
Growth	—	× 3.5	× 3.0
Team	190,000	420,000	700,000
AI & infrastructure	15,000	40,000	90,000
Marketing & ambassadors	40,000	90,000	180,000
Sales, operations & legal	45,000	100,000	180,000
Total costs	**290,000**	**650,000**	**1,150,000**
Result (EBITDA)	**−175,000**	**−253,000**	**+41,000**

Team size: 4 full-time in year 1 (partners in business & finance, 2 engineers, growth/sales), 9 in year 2, 14 in year 3. **Key sensitivity:** if university licences slip by six months, year-3 revenue falls to about €0.8M and break-even moves into year 4; the student business alone would not cover costs, so the pilots-to-licences conversion is the number to watch.

7 · FUNDING

€400k for 18 months.

The pre-seed covers the year-1 loss (€175k) and the first half of year 2 (≈ €127k), plus a 25% buffer, so we raise the seed round from strength rather than in a panic.

USE OF FUNDS	SHARE	€	WHAT IT PAYS FOR
Product	45%	180,000	2 engineers, AI and infrastructure: video clipper, slide generator, accounts, spaced repetition, professor dashboard
Growth	30%	120,000	Ambassador programme in 10 universities, campaigns, events
Sales & operations	25%	100,000	University pilots and sales, legal (GDPR, contracts), admin
Total	**100%**	**400,000**	

milestones the money buys

WHEN	MILESTONE
Months 0–6	AI video clipper and slide generator live; 3 professor pilots; 5,000 registered students
Months 6–12	20,000 registered students; 1,000 paying; 6 paid university licences
Months 12–18	€25k monthly revenue; seed round (≈ €1.5M) to expand to Portugal, Italy and France

key risks and how we handle them

RISK	MITIGATION
Students don't come back after the novelty	Measure week-2 return in pilots; exam-date nudges; recall questions make progress visible; kill or change features that don't move retention
AI content is wrong	Cards only use uploaded material, link to the source slide or timestamp, professor approval before release
Slow university sales	Student-led adoption first; free pilot term; sell per programme, not whole university
Big players copy features	Course-level content, professor relationships, data on most-missed concepts
Content rights and privacy	Professor consent, link not re-host videos, GDPR data minimisation, university DPAs

sources and assumptions

- EU students: "In the EU, there were 19.1 million tertiary education students in 2024." Eurostat, Statistics Explained, Tertiary education statistics (ec.europa.eu/eurostat).
- Spain: 1.827 million university students, academic year 2024–25. Wikipedia, Higher education in Spain, citing Cadena SER (16 Sep 2025). To confirm against the Ministry of Universities' official statistics.
- IE University: "10,000+ students", Wikipedia infobox, uncited. To confirm with IE.
- Prices, conversion, retention, costs and licence values are the team's planning assumptions, to be validated with pilot data and a willingness-to-pay survey.